

The Home screen provides you information about the state of your computer: whether your spyware definitions need updating, the last time you scanned your system for spyware. Clicking on the Scan button will initiate a quick scan of your computer. If you wish to do a selective scan, you can do so via the drop-down arrow adjacent to the Scan button, which allows you to start a Custom Scan. Clicking on the Tools button lets you set a variety of options such as 'Allowed items', where you may exclude certain applications that are known to trigger false alarms. The last option which is Software Explorer lets you view processes in your Windows, but with much more information than the Task Manager offers, such as the name of the process and what else is running within that process.

Windows Defender is memory resident. Surprisingly, there is no system tray icon for this application. Archive formats such as ZIP are silently scanned and stopped before a spyware can be installed. It works in conjunction with IE 6 and 7 in Windows XP SP2 and 2003 SP1. It can block attempts to run suspect files. Automatic update keeps the Windows Defender up to speed by downloading the latest spyware definitions from Microsoft's Web site.

4.4.7 SpywareBlaster 3.5.1

www.javacoolsoftware.com

SpywareBlaster from Javacool Software is a free antispyware with a difference. Unlike similar applications, this one does not run in the background all the time. The installation is fairly simple and on the first run, you are guided through an introductory tutorial.

The main screen displays security information on your system and possible steps needed to increase its security.

The SnapShot section lets you take a snap of your system while it is in a good, clean state and save it or restore to it, similar to the System Restore option in Windows XP. The Tools